

ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)
ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION
O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/2
PAPER 2 November 2019

2 hours

PAPER 2 — READING — COMPREHENSION, SUMMARY, REGISTER — 2 HOURS

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to November 2019 1122/2.

Additional materials: The passage is printed in this paper. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions. Spend about 1 hour 30 minutes on Section A (comprehension and summary) and 30 minutes on Section B (register).

SECTION A (40 marks) — Comprehension and summary

PASSAGE

The drift
Tawanda stood at the edge of the drift and measured the brown water with his eyes. Yesterday it had been a shallow place where cattle crossed, stones showing like the backs of sleeping hippos. Overnight the river had risen, carrying sticks and a yellow jerrycan that spun as if it were late for an appointment. His English Language paper began at half past eight in the school beyond the ridge. He had no watch, but the light said he had very little time. An old man sat under a msasa tree, a bicycle wheel across his knees. “If you wait, the water will think about going down,” he said. “If you do not wait, the water will not think about you.” Tawanda laughed because it was expected, then stopped laughing because the words were not a joke. He thought of his uncle, who had paid for the examination fee by selling two goats, and of the teacher who had said, “You have a quiet talent. Do not waste it on lateness.” Two girls from the next village arrived, school shoes in plastic bags, skirts held above the wet grass. They looked at the drift, then at Tawanda, as if he were part of the weather. He felt suddenly older than sixteen. “We can try the fallen tree upstream,” he said, though he had never tried it with a river like this. They walked in single file. The trunk was slimy. Midway, Tawanda’s satchel swung and a textbook slipped, opened, and sailed away like a cheap boat. He almost went after it, then gripped the bark until his palms burned. On the far bank they put on their shoes without speaking. Mud painted their calves. The first girl whispered, “Thank you,” as if a louder word might wake the river. They ran. At the gate the prefect was already closing the bolt. Tawanda’s name was the last on the register. He sat down, hands still shaking, and wrote his name as if it were the most important sentence he would produce that morning. Outside, far away, the yellow jerrycan was still travelling.

2. (a) How had the drift changed overnight? [2] (b) What two thoughts make Tawanda unwilling to turn back? [3] (c) Why does the old man’s remark stop being funny? [3] (d) What does the loss of the textbook show about Tawanda’s priorities? [4] (e) How does the writer create tension in the last paragraph? [4] (f) Explain the meaning of: (i) “he had no watch, but the light said he had very little time” [2] (ii) “as if he were part of the weather” [2]
[20]

- 3.** In not more than 160 words, summarise Tawanda's journey to the examination room and the decisions he makes. Use continuous prose. [20] **[20]**

SECTION B (10 marks) — Register · Answer ALL

4. On WhatsApp, your aunt asks you to greet your mother. You reply: **[2]**

- A) I will pass on your greetings, Aunt. Thank you.
- B) Tell her yourself lol.
- C) Mom is annoying today.
- D) K

5. Writing to a Head about a leaking classroom, the complementary close should be: **[2]**

- A) See you
- B) Yours faithfully
- C) Love
- D) Yours

6. You answer a landline in an office. The proper opening is: **[2]**

- A) Yes?
- B) Good morning, Mutasa High School, may I help you?
- C) Who is this?
- D) Talk, I'm listening.

7. A tourist in your town asks if it is 'safe'. The most appropriate reply is: **[2]**

- A) This place is a jungle, run.
- B) I don't talk to foreigners.
- C) Why, are you scared?
- D) Generally yes, but keep your bag closed and use registered taxis.

8. You are late for a lesson. When you enter, you should say: **[2]**

- A) The other class is also late.
- B) May I come in, Sir/Madam? I am sorry I am late.
- C) It's not my fault, the bell is wrong.
- D) What did I miss?

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).